Sanen Kinsen Hiroku

Three Monkeys Gold Spring Secret Record

三猿金泉秘録

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A Secret Record on the Art of Rice Market Speculation

from the Edo Period of Japan

Source text attributed to
牛田権三郎
Ushida Gonzaburō

Revised and corrected by
鳴川猛之助
Narukawa Takenosuke

Edited and produced by Zach Booth

Translated with AI assistance

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The complete methodology—including manuscript scans, character-by-character transcription, working translation files, and LaTeX source—is available at https://github.com/groverburger/sanen-kinsen-hiroku.

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About This Edition

This is the first English translation of the *Sanen Kinsen Hiroku*. The manuscript was sourced and the translation project directed by Zach Booth. The original text is in *kobun* (classical Japanese) with *kanbun kundoku* reading marks in cursive script (*kuzushiji*) on aged paper. The translation was produced in two mechanically-separated stages:

1. Transcription. The manuscript images were passed through NDL 古典籍OCR-Lite — a specialist OCR toolchain released by Japan's National Diet Library for Edo-period and earlier classical texts (RTMDet text-region detection + PARSeq character recognition, ONNX, CPU-only). This step is purely mechanical: the model reads pixels, not meaning, and cannot silently interpolate from context it does not have.

2. Translation. The OCR output was then rendered into English with AI assistance (Claude Opus 4.6, Anthropic), working from the mechanical transcription and consulting the manuscript images only to sanity-check OCR artifacts.

On Confidence. Section headers, diagram labels, boxed tables, and structured lists (such as the sexagenary year cycles, the Three-Virtue verse-counts, and the four-stage method- diagrams) are legible in the OCR and reliably translated. The dense prose between these anchors varies: most is readable, but some stretches — particularly the afterword on page 32 and several long interval rows in the body — are fragmentary even to the OCR. Where the underlying transcription is difficult, the translation is marked *[Interpretive]*. Passages so flagged represent the reconstructed sense of the passage; they are not the author's exact words.

How to Read This Translation

The body text of this book is a direct translation of the source manuscript. The chapter and section headings are editorial, added for navigation. Footnotes marked "*Translator's note*" provide historical context, definitions, and comparative observations. Indented passages marked "*Editor's note*" provide brief editorial bridges where the manuscript's structure requires explanation. Chapter lengths vary because the translation follows the manuscript's own proportions — some topics receive extensive treatment in the source, others only a line or two.

Structure of the Text. Chapter 1 is the preface, grounding the book in Neo-Confucian cosmology and naming the Three Monkeys as a contrarian discipline. Chapters 2–3 establish the favorable/adverse year cycle and the enumerated maxims that act on it. Chapter 4 presents the four-stage method-diagrams (half-plank, at-ease, reversal). Chapter 5 is the sixty-year weather almanac. Chapters 6–7 build the decision framework: the Nine-Body Song and the forty-eight verses of the Three Virtues. Chapters 8–11 are the quantitative core: the World-Levels Diagram, the Strong-Qi / Weak-Qi five-stage secrets, the compound trades, the Grand Diagram, and the three first-tier family secrets. Chapter 12 is the editor's afterword.

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Translator's Introduction

The *Sanen Kinsen Hiroku* (三猿金泉秘録), or "Three Monkeys Gold Spring Secret Record," is one of the most celebrated texts in the history of Japanese market speculation.[1]

The title alludes to the proverb of the three monkeys—"see no evil, hear no evil, speak no evil" (見ざる、聞かざる、言わざる)—reinterpreted as a warning to the trader: do not be swayed by what you *see* others doing, what you *hear* as rumor, or what you *say* in haste. Instead, observe the deeper patterns.

Authorship and the Edo Rice Market

The manuscript names its author as Ushida Gonzaburō (牛田権三郎), an Osaka Dōjima trader from Ise province who wrote under the pen name Jiunsai (慈雲斎). The text was composed around 1755 and later revised and corrected by Narukawa Takenosuke (鳴川猛之助). It belongs to a genre of "secret market transmission texts" (相場秘伝書, *sōba hidensho*) that circulated among Edo-period trading houses.[2]

During the Tokugawa period (1603–1868), rice was the basis of the economy. The Dōjima Rice Exchange (堂島米会所) in Osaka functioned as a sophisticated futures market where "book rice" (帳合米) was traded as forward contracts.[3]

A Note on Attribution

English-language sources almost universally attribute this text to Honma Munehisa (本間宗久) of Sakata, often under the title "The Fountain of Gold—The Three Monkey Record of Money." This attribution is incorrect.

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[1] *Translator's note:* The manuscript is dated 嘉永四年五月廿日 (1851) and identifies itself as a copy of the Kōmondō (好問堂) edition, published at Igarashi-tsu (五十嵐津). The text references the Tenmei era (1781–1789) extensively for its price data.

[2] *Translator's note:* The inner title page of the manuscript appears to bear a small label that may read 三猿軍書選 (*Sanen gunsho sen*, "Selection from the Three Monkeys Military/Strategy Books"), though the label is partially obscured and this reading is uncertain.

[3] *Translator's note:* The Dōjima Rice Exchange was established in 1697 as a spot market. Organized futures trading (帳合米) was formally authorized by the shogunate in 1730, making it one of the world's first organized futures markets.

The manuscript names its author as Ushida Gonzaburō and its editor as Narukawa Takenosuke—as do the National Diet Library catalog, the CiNii bibliographic record, and every Japanese-language reference work that discusses it. In Japanese scholarship, this is not controversial: the NDL, CiNii, Kyoto University's digital archive, and sources from Honma's own hometown (the Shonai Securities company of Sakata) all attribute the *Sanen Kinsen Hiroku* to Ushida.

Honma Munehisa was a real historical figure—a Sakata trader who was expelled from his own family for speculating with company capital and who became legendary in his own right. Texts were later attributed to him (the *Sōkyū-ō Hiroku* and *Sōba Sanmai-den*), though no Edo-period originals of these survive; Japanese scholars suspect they were compiled in the Meiji era. Honma's texts have entirely different titles and contents from Ushida's.

The confusion appears to have entered English through Steve Nison's influential *Japanese Candlestick Charting Techniques* (1991), a book that did enormous service in introducing Japanese technical analysis to Western traders. In synthesizing a large body of Japanese-language material for an English-speaking audience, Nison consolidated several distinct figures and texts into a single narrative—an understandable simplification given the complexity of the source tradition. Nison himself corrected the record in *Beyond Candlesticks* (1994, p. 14), writing that his research indicated Honma "likely did not use candlestick charts." But the first book reached millions of readers, and the broader conflation of names and titles took on a life of its own.

In the decades since, English sources have merged Ushida's title with Honma's name, creating a phantom text: "The Fountain of Gold" (金泉) and "Three Monkeys" (三猿) are both from Ushida's title; the Honma texts have completely different names. Two English-language books have been published under variations of this text's title. Neither translates it. Both render a separate body of trading maxims from the Honma/Sakata tradition—a related but distinct lineage—while putting Ushida's title on the cover.

What follows is, to my knowledge, the first English translation of the actual *Sanen Kinsen Hiroku*, made directly from the 1851 manuscript held at Kyoto University.

A Note on Method

The translation proceeds in two mechanically-separated stages. The cursive manuscript pages are first read by a specialist optical- character-recognition toolchain, NDL 古典籍OCR-Lite, released by Japan's National Diet Library for Edo-period and earlier classical texts. The OCR is mechanical: it reads pixels and emits characters, with no interpretive access to the text's meaning. An LLM (Claude Opus 4.6, Anthropic) then works from the mechanical transcription to produce the English, consulting the manuscript images only to sanity-check OCR artifacts.

The separation is deliberate. A single model asked to read cursive script and produce English in one pass has no way to distinguish between characters it has read and characters it has guessed, because both are generated by the same mechanism. Splitting the two stages makes the distinction visible: where the OCR failed, the book says so; where the OCR returned a plausibly-wrong character, the correction is flagged inline. Every English sentence is traceable back to a specific line of mechanical transcription, which is traceable back to a specific pixel-region of the manuscript scan.

The full audit trail — the manuscript scans, the mechanical transcription at the character level, and the translation files — is published alongside this book at the URL given in the back matter.

—Zach Booth

Chapter 1

The Preface: Cosmology of the Market

三猿金泉録序

Preface to the Three Monkeys Gold Spring Record

The preface of the *Sanen Kinsen Hiroku* is written in Chinese- derived prose with Japanese *kundoku* reading marks, in a hand more formal than the body of the text. Its opening places the rice market inside the Neo-Confucian cosmology of the Supreme Ultimate and the alternation of yin and yang, and proceeds through a sequence of definitions that establish the book's working vocabulary: the strong and weak forces (強気 (*kyōki*) / 弱気 (*jakki*)); the principle beyond ordinary nature (天性理外の理 (*tensei rigai no ri*)); the empty principle (空理 (*kūri*)); and the fixed form (定式 (*jōshiki*)) by which a method becomes practicable.

1.1 The Supreme Ultimate

THE SUPREME ULTIMATE[1] moves and begets Yang; its motion reaches its limit and becomes still. In stillness it begets Yin; stillness reaches its limit and moves again. Movement and stillness are the root of one another.

The rise and fall of rice — like the circuit of Heaven and Earth, and of Yin and Yang — alternates between strong-spirited force and weak-spirited force. Each contains the seed of its opposite: when the strong force has driven prices to their ceiling, the weak force is already present within it; when the weak force has driven them to their floor, the strong force is likewise already present.

[1] *Translator's note:* 太極 (*taikyoku*) — the foundational concept of Neo-Confucian cosmology. The opening echoes Zhou Dunyi's *Taijitu shuo* (*Explanation of the Diagram of the Supreme Ultimate*, mid-11th c.), grounding market theory in the highest philosophical authority available to an Edo-period reader.

> *When the crowd's spirit is weak, it is the principle of rice's rising. When the crowd's spirit is strong, it is the seed of rice's falling. All of this is the principle beyond ordinary nature* (天性理外の理, *tensei rigai no ri*).

1.2 Sixty Years of Study

The preface turns, at this point, to the autobiographical frame on which everything that follows rests:

> *For sixty years I have cast my mind upon this craft, devising by day and by night, and have at length opened up the insight into rice's strong and weak forces. I have established the settled method of rice trading, and have compiled a single volume of secret writings, giving it the title* **Three Monkeys Gold Spring Record.**

Six decades of study is a weighty claim. It positions this book as the summation of a working life's observation, not a younger trader's prospectus. Every maxim, every diagram, every calibrated drawdown ladder in the body of the text is offered as what such a sixty-year span yielded.

1.3 The Shape of the Rice Grain

The preface now turns to the book's central emblem:

> *The form of the rice grain: rounded in the middle, pointed at top and bottom. The round is Yang; the pointed is Yin.*

This single sentence is the seed of the entire diagrammatic tradition that follows. The grain itself becomes the emblem for the candle-and-spike pattern of a market print. The same figure will recur in the 穂足の録 (*Hosoku no Roku*) ("Record of Spike Patterns") and in the four-stage cycle diagrams of Chapter 4.

1.4 The Four Classes and the Three Monkeys

The preface now names the book's broader audience and its guiding emblem of discipline:

> *Receiving the breath of Heaven, Earth, Yin and Yang, [rice] nourishes the four classes — warrior, farmer, artisan, merchant — and is the first treasure of all under Heaven.*[2]
>
> *The Three Monkeys are: the See-Monkey, the Hear-Monkey, and the Speak-Monkey.*

And then, built on that triad, the book's foundational rule:

> *When the eye perceives strong-spiritedness, do not let the heart sink into the abyss of that strength. Hold it only within the heart, and* sell.
>
> *When the ear hears weak-spiritedness, do not let the heart sink into the abyss of that weakness. Hold it only within the heart, and* buy.
>
> *Whether you see or hear the strong or the weak, do not speak of it to others. Words lead hearts astray. This is the secret of the three monkeys.*

This is the contrarian discipline that gives the book its title. The monkeys are not a moralizing ornament but a working rule for trading against the crowd.

1.5 The Empty Principle and the Fixed Form

The preface closes with a philosophical move that justifies the enterprise of the whole book: the market's motion is ultimately empty, but it has a discernible form, and from the form one can derive a method.

> *The principle of highs and lows is an* empty principle (空理, *kūri*) *— not visible to the eye; a thing whose very body is without shade or form.*

Two readings of "empty" are then distinguished. The first: if we take it only as empty, we will find no hour in a thousand years to buy or sell. The second: even the formless has a body; where there is a body, there is a fixed form (定式 (*jōshiki*)); where there is a fixed form, there is a trade.

[2] *Translator's note:* 士農工商 (*shi-nō-kō-shō*), the classical Japanese social stratification. The OCR stream has a small fragment (士略) at this point consistent with the 士農 opening of the standard list.

The preface then places the trader's discipline alongside the three great teachings of its culture:

> *The fixed form of Buddhism is the Five Precepts. The fixed form of Confucianism is the Five Constants. The fixed form of Shinto is the Three Virtues of Wisdom, Benevolence and Courage. Each has its own fixed form.*

By naming a "fixed form" for rice-trading and then enumerating it alongside the forms of the three teachings, the preface concludes with the claim the book will then spend thirty pages demonstrating: the trader's discipline is not a craft beside the philosophies — it is a philosophy in its own right, and its book is the record of its form.

Chapter 2

Favorable and Adverse Years

The preface closes with the reciprocal definition that opens the body of the text. Of years in which old rice is abundant and its low price transfers to the new harvest, the book says: *this is called a* 順来 (*junrai*) — *a favorable year*. Of years in which rice is scarce and the high price transfers onward, even if a summer rally appears: *this is a year of downward force, and we call it a* 逢来 (*airai*) — *an adverse year*.

2.1 The Twelve-to-Thirteen Year Cycle

The book's opening structural claim is a cycle of twelve to thirteen years, within which the favorable years typically outnumber the adverse by roughly ten to three:

> *The way of following favorable conditions and adverse conditions — within a period of twelve or thirteen years, the favorable years run to roughly ten and the adverse to three.*

The author presents his method as a table-of-contents in miniature, naming the eight structural sections that together comprise what he calls the "settled form" (定式 (*jōshiki*)) of rice trading: the Twelve-Cycle Trading of favorable and adverse years; the Family- Tradition Mirror of Highs and Lows; the Thirty-Eight Articles of Trading; the Fifteen Prohibitions; and the Annual Record of Fortune-Qi and Plenty-and-Want, among others.

> *Studied through, this is the wondrous art that does not lose once in a thousand attempts. Truly, the secret treasure of the family. Keep it secret, keep it secret.*

2.2 The Attribution

Immediately following that injunction, the manuscript records a date and a signature that situates the text in time and lineage:

> 宝暦五年秋九月下旬 — *Late ninth month, autumn of Hōreki 5* (**1755**).
>
> 慈雲斎　牛田権三郎 — *Jiunsai, Ushida Gonzaburō*.

The pen name 慈雲斎 (*Jiunsai*) appears here, directly above Ushida's given name. This is the only place in the book where the pen name is recorded. The date — *Hōreki* 5, **1755** — places the text's original composition nearly a century before the 1851 revised printing recorded in the colophon on the opening leaf, indicating that Narukawa's edition is the print recension of a much older family manuscript tradition.

2.3 The Twelve-Cycle Trading of Favorable and Adverse Years

The section header that opens the main body reads:

> ○順来逢来十二平商内　〔天明本〕
>
> *The Twelve-Cycle Trading of Favorable and Adverse Years — Tenmei recension*

The annotation 天明本 (*Tenmei-bon*) — "the Tenmei-era recension" — is one of several running textual-parallel markers that recur throughout the book, indicating this section descends from a Tenmei- era (1781–1789) version of the manuscript.

The section is set in verse. Each sub-group contains six verse-lines per year-type. A representative pair:

> *Favorable year, autumn-and-winter highs and lows:*
>
> *Autumn cheap; an upward force; one and a half steps; the eleventh month falls; the year-end rises.*
>
> *Spring breaks; the fourth and fifth months go down; the rice of the sixth and seventh months goes down.*
>
> *Favorable year, six verses on the trading method:*
>
> *In autumn, buy; on the upward thrust, sell out and reverse; turn again on the auspicious month; the year-end is at ease.*
>
> *In spring, reverse; in the fourth and fifth months, buy; at the end of the fifth month, sow this seed; settle by the end of the sixth, seventh, and eighth months.*

Each year-type — favorable and adverse — receives twelve verse-lines: six on the expected highs and lows, and six on the trading method that responds to them.

2.4 The Family Tradition: Mirror of the Four Seasons

A second verse-cycle, more elaborate, is then introduced under the header:

> ○家伝四季高安鑑　第二天明本
>
> *Family Tradition: Mirror of the Four Seasons' Highs and Lows — Tenmei Recension, Second Section*

Where the preceding verses addressed the year-type directly, the *Mirror of the Four Seasons* re-presents the same material organized by season. The trader is given a paired read for each season-within-each-year-type — what to expect in autumn and winter under a favorable year, what to expect in spring under an adverse year, and so on — before the text moves into its first enumerated maxim-treatise, the Thirty-Eight Articles.

Chapter 3

The Thirty-Eight Articles and the Fifteen Prohibitions

The two enumerated sections treated in this chapter form the backbone of the book's first half. Each is a series of short maxim-verses (歌 (*uta*)), each opening with the enumerative particle 一 — "one."

3.1 The Thirty-Eight Articles of Trading

The section header reads simply 三十八ヶ条商内 (*sanjūhachi-kajō shōnai*) — "Thirty-Eight Articles of Trading" — with a small preliminary "three articles" (三ヶ条 (*san-kajō*)) grouping at the head. The furigana gloss あきない (*akinai*) is visible alongside 商内, confirming the native (*wakan*) reading rather than the Sino-Japanese *shōnai*.

What follows is a selection of articles grouped thematically. The full enumeration is preserved in the transcription file.

3.1.1 Year-Reads and the Spread Signal

> *A favorable year: a downward force followed by a rise. At the harvest moon of autumn, sow the seed of buying.*
>
> *An adverse year: a downward force followed by a further fall. At the harvest moon of autumn, sow the seed of selling.*
>
> *When the spread (鞘, sayagahari) flips from below-spread to above-spread, after the downward thrust comes the rise — close out your position on the gain.*
>
> *When the spread flips from above to below, after the downward thrust comes the further decline — close out your position on the gain.*

3.1.2 The Two-Hundred-Tenth Day

> *The year when strong-spiritedness emerges is set: select it, and on the* two-hundred-tenth day **(二百十日, *nihyaku-tōka*)** *sow the seed of buying.*

> *A monk says: studying the* Annual Record of Fortune-Qi and Plenty-and-Want *(the almanac presented in Chapter 5), one cultivates the strong-spirited stance and, on the two-hundred-tenth day, sows the seed of buying — this is the sense of the verse.*

The two-hundred-tenth day from the start of the lunar year falls in early September — the seasonal pivot that recurs throughout the book as a buying signal.

3.1.3 On Public Sentiment

> *The ear catching strong-spiritedness in the public voice is itself the seed of rice's coming fall.*
>
> *When weak-spiritedness has emerged into the open, everyone turns strong-spirited without judgment — sow the seed of selling.*
>
> *The year in which weak-spiritedness fails to emerge into the world is one in which rice ought to rise.*

3.1.4 The Contrarian Maxims

> *If a rice whose climbing pace is plainly visible is in front of you, halt — stay your strong spirit and sell.*
>
> *The man who is forever weak-spirited, knowing nothing of loss or gain — call him a great timid one, a parishioner of the poverty god.*

3.1.5 The Rhythm of the Year

> *The great rule: late in the fifth month is the appointed time of selling; the harvest moon of autumn is the ripening of buying.*
>
> *If the year accords with what the multitude expects, better to set out for an unfrequented path.*
>
> *To buy your rice in a single stroke is rashness. Buy in two; sell in two.*

The Thirty-Eight Articles close with two maxims that introduce a reference-concept carrying forward into the diagrams of Chapter 4:

> *Across a hundred* tsubo *of land, ninety-nine years of highs and lows do not exceed three steps — take this for fact.*

> *Even by a single move, when the step has risen, it is nine-myriad one* bu*; know it as the selling season at the* celestial origin *of a thousand.*

The term 天元 (*tengen*) — "celestial origin" — will reappear as the top stage-marker of every position ladder in the book.

3.2 The Fifteen Prohibitions

The section that follows is the paired negative half of the Thirty-Eight Articles: fifteen short *don't-do-this* injunctions, each opening from a market condition and ending with the phrase 禁制 (*kinsei*) — "trading is forbidden."

The section header is ambiguous in the manuscript — 〇十五禁言 at one point, 十五首 at another — but the received reading is 十五ヶ条禁制 (*jūgo-kajō kinsei*), "the Fifteen Articles of Prohibition." A running red-ink numeral 十四 at the head binds the section into the larger enumerated count of the book.

3.2.1 Representative Prohibitions

> *When a trade is without its proper attendant, then whether or not any gain or loss may be, trading is* forbidden.
>
> *An abundant harvest: the multitude grows weak-spirited; I too grow weak. Coming into autumn, selling is forbidden.*
>
> *A lean harvest: the minor-spirit is strong, and stronger again; when rice is plentiful, buying is forbidden.*
>
> *When the rising step is so visible that even the rice itself seems to say so, though the year is strong, selling in the fourth month is forbidden.*
>
> *Fifth-month rice — sentiment weak, yet the price rises. Until the strength is clearly in, selling is forbidden.*
>
> *On great floods or great winds sending rice spiking upward — in any year, buying is forbidden.*

The structural pattern is consistent across the fifteen: identify a market condition; identify the direction the crowd will take; name the direction the trader must *not* take. The prohibitions are the contrarian discipline of the Three Monkeys worked out in fifteen specific cases.

Chapter 4

The Method Diagrams: Half-Plank, At-Ease, Reversal

The book now shifts from verse and maxim to diagram. The method-diagrams treated in this chapter are the book's signature contribution: four-stage sequential cycles in which the trader executes a specific sequence of buys and sells as the market moves up and down through a single cycle. Each diagram in the manuscript is drawn as a four-cell figure with a red-circled numeral — ①②③④ — at each cell marking the order of operations.

> *Editor's note:* These are not branching decision trees. Each diagram specifies the *fixed sequence* of four actions that constitute one complete cycle. The differences between the three diagrams lie in the size-relationship between the buy and sell legs — which in turn determines whether the cycle leaves the trader net long, net flat, or net short at its close.

4.1 The Autumn-Moon Eight-Hundred-Ryō Ladder

Before the four-stage diagrams proper, the manuscript presents a worked scaling ladder on page 10, keyed to the autumn harvest moon and to the two-hundred-tenth day. The header reads:

> 大黒天神秋名月商内并二百十日商
>
> *The Daikoku-deity's autumn-harvest-moon trade, together with the two-hundred-tenth-day trade.*
>
> 買桶三平二来半板安楽商内
>
> *Using the buy-bucket, three-flats-two-comings-half-plank-at-ease method.*

The ladder builds an 800-*ryō* position across six named stages: 天元 (*tengen*) (the celestial-origin base reference), 一乗 (*ichijō*), 二来 (*nirai*), 三平 (*sanpei*), 半板 (*hanban*), and 安楽 (*anraku*) (at ease). The three totals given in plain prose at the head of the ladder are unambiguous:

> *Summed: an 800-ryō buy, seventy* tawara *of accumulated rice, approximately thirty* ryō *in payment, forty* ryō *in deposit — altogether seventy* ryō.

The oral tradition — 口伝 (*kuden*) — declares its governing use: *"In the harvest-moon trade, one ought to use this diagram as the square-rule and trade by it."*

A mirror instruction at the foot of the ladder establishes its reversibility: *"When reversed, it becomes an 800-ryō sell. In the trade before the two-hundred-tenth day, likewise, one ought to trade by this diagram as the square-rule."*

A sister ladder on page 11, keyed to the shrines of Nishinomiya Ebisu and Sumiyoshi Daimyōjō, runs a 600-*ryō* variant with a 30-*tawara* bucket subtraction, and another runs a 400-*ryō* trade with a 転変 (*tenpen*) reversal at the pivot. The same stage-names (*tengen*, *ichijō*, *nirai*, *sanpei*, *hanban*, *anraku*) recur throughout.

4.2 The Half-Plank Diagram

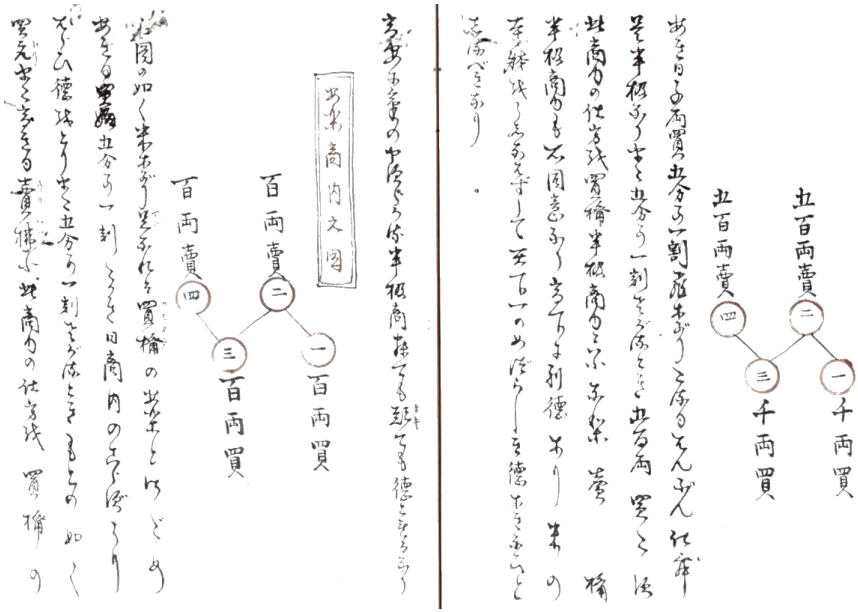

Figure 4.1: *
Manuscript page 12: the *half-plank* (半板商内之図, right) and the *at-ease* (安楽商内之図, left) figures, each shown as a four-stage sequential cycle with red-circled stage-numerals ①②③④.

半板商内之図
Half-Plank Trade Diagram

Four stages, alternating 1000-*ryō* buy and 500-*ryō* sell:

Stage	Action	Intent
① one	千両買 (1000-*ryō* BUY)	initial position
② two	五百両売 (500-*ryō* SELL)	partial unwind on a rise
③ three	千両買 (1000-*ryō* BUY)	re-enter on pull-back
④ four	五百両売 (500-*ryō* SELL)	partial unwind on a rise

Net across the full four stages: **2000 bought, 1000 sold — 1000 held long** at a reduced average cost. The name *half-plank* (半板, *hanban*) refers to the half-unwind at each up-move: the trader is always running with half his plank still underfoot.

The explanatory prose continues:

> *On an autumn day, in a light rain, buy — and as the spike runs five-*bu *to one-*koku, *settle out the half. This is the* half-plank.
>
> *When the next five-*bu *decline arrives, roll back into a 500-*ryō *buy.*

The method-summary that follows is one of the book's most direct ethical claims:

> *There is gain in both rise and fall, without losing the essence of the rice — it is the rarest method under Heaven, and its profit is far beyond the ordinary. Know this.*

4.3 The At-Ease Diagram

安楽商内之図
At-Ease Trade Diagram

The at-ease figure is the half-plank's scaled-down, net-flat analogue. Same four-stage sequential cycle, all legs at the 100-*ryō* scale and alternating buy/sell at the same size so the net position is flat at the end of each complete cycle:

Stage	Action	Intent
① one	百両買 (100-*ryō* BUY)	entry
② two	百両売 (100-*ryō* SELL)	exit on up-move
③ three	百両買 (100-*ryō* BUY)	re-enter on pull-back
④ four	百両売 (100-*ryō* SELL)	exit on up-move

Net across the cycle: 200 bought, 200 sold — flat. The method captures the oscillation between the 5%-to-one-step bands on either side of a reference price without carrying any overnight directional exposure. Hence *at ease* (安楽 (*anraku*)).

> *On a fall-off day of five*-bu-*to-one*-koku, *sell out without remainder, take the profit, and when the price declines by another five*-bu-*to-one*-koku, *buy again as at first; when it rises swiftly, sell out.*

4.4 The Reversal Diagram

転変商内之図
Reversal Trade Diagram

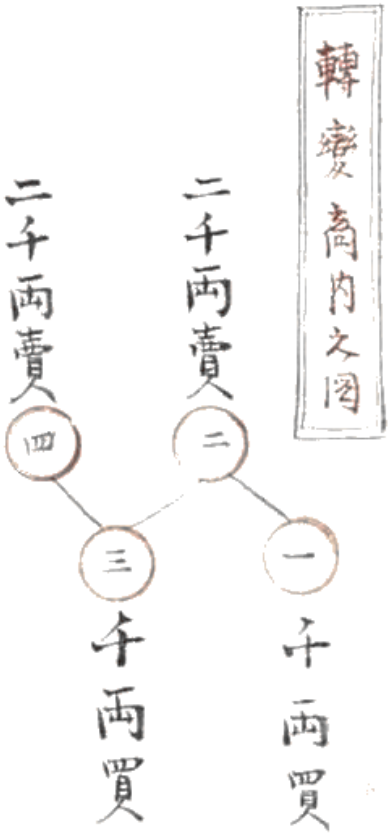

Figure 4.2: *
Manuscript page 13: the *reversal* (転変商内之図) figure — four stages, with the sell-legs (②, ④) each double the size of the buy-legs.

The third of the four-stage cycle figures. Same geometric layout as the half-plank and at-ease, but with a different size-relationship between the buy and sell legs: each sell is now **twice** the size of each buy.

Stage	Action	Intent
① one	千両買 (1000-*ryō* BUY)	entry
② two	二千両売 (2000-*ryō* SELL)	double-size sell on rise
③ three	千両買 (1000-*ryō* BUY)	re-cover on pull-back
④ four	二千両売 (2000-*ryō* SELL)	double-size sell on rise

Net across the cycle: 2000 bought, 4000 sold — **2000 held short** at the end. Where the half-plank keeps the trader long-biased and the at-ease keeps him flat, the reversal figure flips him from long to short within a single market cycle. The ② and ④ legs each unwind the prior buy and simultaneously open a short of equal size.

The explanatory prose distinguishes two mirror forms of the method — the 買桶転変 (*kai-oke tenpen*) (buy-bucket reversal) and the 売桶転変 (*uri-oke tenpen*) (sell-bucket reversal) — and frames both as responses to the market's own tempo:

> *Without straining against the fundamental nature of the rice, following the strong-and-weak force of the thing in sequence — this is the secret of reversal-trading.*
>
> *The reversal-trade, timed to the rhythm of the saw's teeth — step into it and you cool the whole body.*

Chapter 5

The Sixty-Year Fortune-Qi Almanac

The manuscript now opens its empirical core: a year-by-year categorization of the sixty-year sexagenary (干支 (*kanshi*)) cycle by expected weather and harvest conditions. The full section is called:

> 万歳運気豊凶録
>
> *The Ten-Thousand-Year Record of Fortune-Qi: Plenty and Want*

The section's opening line gives the empirical base on which the whole categorization rests:

> 二百十三年、二来半板出染転変商内
>
> *Compiled from two hundred thirteen years. The two-stage, half-plank, carry-over-and-reverse trade.*

What follows is an enumeration of every year in the sixty-year sexagenary cycle, grouped into seven weather categories. The counts sum exactly to sixty — the editor's red-ink annotation at the section's close declares this plainly: 以上、大周六十年 なり — *"The above completes the great cycle of sixty years."*

	Category	Years
1	暴風 Violent winds	12
2	洪水 Great floods	5
3	寒冷 Cold and chill	3
4	霖雨 Continuous rains	2
5	極凶 Extreme misfortune	8
6	豊作 Abundant harvest	28
7	中豊作 Middling abundance	2
	Total	**60**

Each category carries a red-ink margin annotation glossing its five-element correlation: 暴風 is paired with *wood-qi in concentrated eruption* (木気鬱発); 洪水 with *greater-yin damp earth* (太陰濕土); 霖雨 with *bright-yang shining metal* and *greater-yang cold water* (陽明輝金 / 太陽寒水); 豊作 with *warm- transformation* (温化画).

5.1 Violent Winds — Twelve Years

The twelve sexagenary years of violent wind-disaster:

> 甲子 (*Kinoe-Ne*), 丁卯 (*Hinoto-U*), 丁丑 (*Hinoto-Ushi*), 辛巳 (*Kanoto-Mi*), 甲申 (*Kinoe-Saru*), 辛卯 (*Kanoto-U*), 甲午 (*Kinoe-Uma*), 丁酉 (*Hinoto-Tori*), 丁未 (*Hinoto-Hitsuji*), 辛亥 (*Kanoto-I*), 甲寅 (*Kinoe-Tora*), 辛酉 (*Kanoto-Tori*).
>
> *The years listed above are in themselves middling-ordinary years. However, when wood-qi erupts as an aberrant force and fire- winds blow through the seventh and eighth months, they become years of great disaster.*

5.2 Great Floods — Five Years

> 己巳, 己卯, 己亥, 己酉, 壬戌.
>
> *The listed years are in themselves middling-early years. But when earth-qi erupts aberrantly and great floods sweep the fields through the seventh and eighth months, they become years of great disaster.*

5.3 Cold and Chill — Three Years

> 乙丑, 乙未, 乙巳.
>
> *For this category, there is no settled method for trading. Reflect and consider.*

5.4 Continuous Rains — Two Years

> 癸未, 癸丑.
>
> *The years above are years of strong cold in which the ten thousand things cannot easily flourish — great disaster years. However, if the aberrant force of fire-qi erupts in the sixth and seventh months, they become years of easy abundance.*

5.5 Extreme Misfortune — Eight Years

This category carries the frankest editorial gloss in the book: *No prescribed method. Reflect.* — and with reason: the OCR for the list of eight years at this point in the manuscript returns a duplicated block, and only three readings can be individually confirmed without reference to the manuscript image.

> 丙寅, 丙午, 庚戌, … *(five further sexagenary readings; the complete list should be checked against the manuscript image before citation).*

5.6 Abundant Harvest — Twenty-Eight Years

The largest category in the calendar, and the one in which the book's method applies in its fullest form:

> *These are the years in which one trades by the method of three-flats, two-stage, half-plank, at-ease, and reversal, at the autumn harvest moon.*

Twenty-eight sexagenary years, running in order:

> 戊辰, 庚午, 辛未, 壬申, 癸酉, 甲戌, 乙亥, 戊寅, 乙酉, 丙戌, 丁亥, 戊子, 己丑, 庚寅, 癸巳, 戊戌, 庚寅, 辛丑, 壬寅, 癸卯, 甲辰, 戊申, 乙卯, 丙辰, 丁巳, 己未, 庚申, 癸亥.

5.7 Middling Abundance — Two Years

> 戊午, 壬辰.
>
> *Although these are abundant-even years, they are only the middling harbinger.*

5.8 The Tide and Wind-Free Almanacs

The chapter closes with two short practical almanacs that served the pre-industrial rice trader's single largest external risk — shipping interruption.

5.8.1 On Great and Small Tides (大潮小汐の考)

Know the small-tide *days to be: the 6th, 7th, 8th; the 9th; the 10th; the 21st, 22nd; and the 3rd, 4th, 5th.*

All days other than those listed are great-tide. Three days of small-tide are the "great-valley" days — this is when the great winds begin to blow. The wind sets off on the flood tide and dies at the full tide.

The flood-tide each day runs four bu *more, and the ebb runs four* bu *later.*

5.8.2 The Wind-Free Interval

From Kanoe-Saru *for eleven days, and from* Kanoe-Uma *onward — in the intervening range — with* Hinoto-Ushi *as the central day: over the fifteen days above, the wind does not blow.*

From the Kinoe-Tora *day, for seven days further, still no wind. Over these fifteen days of no wind, this is when one puts ships to sea. If by some chance the calm fails, it is an exception — know that even such an exception is only one year in a hundred.*

Chapter 6

Weather Signs and the Nine-Body Song

Page 17 of the manuscript carries an interlude between the year- almanac of the preceding chapter and the Three-Virtues section of the next. It begins with a short set of folk-almanac weather-signs — the kind of practical knowledge that a trader who depended on shipping and harvest-reports would have carried in his head — and closes with the book's most concentrated piece of theoretical poetry: the Nine-Body Song.

6.1 Weather Signs

6.1.1 On the Entry of the Rainy Season (入梅三十日)

> *Know that the rainy season (梅 (tsuyu)) enters at the horse-day beginning the fifth month and opens out at the middle of the sixth.*

6.1.2 On Rainbows (虹図)

> *A morning rainbow — know in advance as a morning-rain sign. The rainbow at sunset, on the other hand, is fair weather.*

6.1.3 The Hassen Twelve Days (八専十二日)

The *hassen* is a traditional twelve-day interval of the sexagenary calendar, running from the 壬子 (*Mizunoe-Ne*) day through the 癸亥 (*Mizunoto-I*) day. The almanac assigns it a specific rain sign:

> *If light rain sets in at the beginning of the* hassen, *know in advance that it will keep raining until the end.*
>
> *If it begins again after a pause, the twelve days — in the saying — pass in an unceasing return-rain that follows the boats.*

6.1.4 On the Standing Cloud (玄雲)

> *A standing cloud mingled with red — know it for wind. White or black — know it for rain.*

6.2 The Nine-Body Song (九躰ノ歌)

The weather-signs give way to the book's most theoretically concentrated passage: a verse-cycle in which the rice market is set against each of the nested Neo-Confucian cosmological bodies in turn. The section opens under the header:

> ○一部極意　九躰ノ歌
>
> *Part One: The Secret — Song of Nine Bodies*

Each body gets a short verse-lemma.

6.2.1 無極 — The Limitless (Mukyōku)

> *The principle of highs and lows is an empty principle — invisible to the eye. A thing whose very body is without shadow and without form.*

6.2.2 太極 — The Supreme Ultimate (Taikyoku)

> *The principle-without-principle that dwells even in the midst of right and wrong — only the rice-market's window.*

6.2.3 陰含陽 — Yin Contains Yang (Ingan'yō)

> *When ten-thousand of ten-thousand are all weak-spirited — rice contains, within itself, the very principle by which it ought to rise.*

6.2.4 陽含陰 — Yang Contains Yin (Yōgan'in)

> *When a thousand of a thousand are all strong-spirited — rice contains, within itself, the very principle by which it ought to plunge.*

6.2.5 高安大法 — The Great Law of Highs and Lows

> *The great flood falls upon the autumn harvest moon; the peak at mid-month; the end of the fifth month — these are the swayings of high and low.*

The five rungs together name a single thought: the market is cosmologically empty (*mukyōku*), yet unified (*taikyoku*); each of its two motions contains the seed of its opposite (*ingan'yō* and *yōgan'in*); and the law by which the two manifest in time is keyed to the year's three seasonal pivots (*hōn-daihō*).

Chapter 7

The Three Virtues — Forty-Eight Verses

The book's largest enumerated section. It opens on page 18 with four short "fixed-form" rules, then proceeds through **forty-eight verse-maxims** organized into three ranks after the classical Confucian virtues:

	Virtue	Verses	Theme
智	*Chi* — Wisdom	10	seeing the pattern, knowing the season
仁	*Jin* — Benevolence	28	patience, waiting, not rushing
勇	*Yū* — Courage	10	acting with the crowd reversed
	Total	**48**	

> *Editor's note:* The manuscript's own self-count makes this explicit: the section- header on page 18 reads 四十八首 — *forty-eight verses* — and the sub-headers for *Wisdom*, *Jin* and *Yū* give their sub-counts (十首, 廿八首, 十首).

7.1 The Four Fixed-Form Rules

Before the virtues begin, the page presents four short headed definitions — each a "fixed form" (定式 (*jōshiki*)) of a specific relation — that bridge the Nine-Body Song of the previous chapter into the enumerated maxims that follow.

7.1.1 天ノ性 — The Nature of Heaven

> *By imperial edict or otherwise — know in advance that the division of the fifth month is the time at which natural profit arises.*

7.1.2 商定式 — The Fixed Form of Trading

> *By edict or otherwise — follow the five-*bu *one- step, and forget the twenty-percent three-step as only silver- string.*

7.1.3 平来定式 — *The Fixed Form of the Ordinary Run*

> *Buying and selling should be balanced at a five-*bu *swing. Another version reads the same way.*

7.1.4 売買定式 — *The Fixed Form of Buying and Selling*

> *Know the buying times as the Dragon-Boat Festival and the harvest moon, with the seasonal anchor at Minazuki (sixth month) and Fumizuki (seventh).*

7.2 Wisdom (智, *Chi*) — Ten Verses

A selection of representative verses. The full ten are preserved in the transcription file.

> *Once you have become a favorable-trader, you know — in a single stroke, even over ten-thousand* ryō *— the secret of the one who lays matters to rest.*

> *To wait is benevolence. To face the market is to know the target of the sell-principle — know it as the wondrous art of the half-bridge trade.*

> *The celestial-origin trading-force may play out even over three years. Know this as the prime-trade epigraph of the flag- master.*

> *The echo of the cut-edge of Minazuki rice — at spring- field time, or in the evening, is a plunge downward.*

> *Fifth-month rice, when sentiment is weak and its station honored even as it climbs — know this as the season of spike-upward trading.*

7.3 Benevolence (仁, *Jin*) — Twenty-Eight Verses

The largest verse-rank in the book. Its editorial gloss gives the key: *"Benevolence is the awaiting of the horse-hour; it is inaka-su — the pulling-back-to-the-country."* A selection of the twenty-eight:

> *Neither rushing the trade nor answering to impatience — to wait until the riding-together of waiting and gaining — this too is benevolence.*

> *Simply: in the urging-urgent trading-force there is no profit. Buy the five-*bu *cheap; sell the five-*bu *high.*

> *The more you hurry a trade, the more you lose. Simply stop; change hands and take another look.*
>
> *Not-rushing-the-buy is the secret of the strong-spirited. Buy on hearing the pattern emerge.*
>
> *Not-rushing-the-sell is the secret of the weak-spirited. In all seasons, wait for the ripening and sell.*
>
> *The cheap prices that are not needed in three years or two — the big-weight hand is the one that waits without rushing.*
>
> *Even in the principle of decline, if the time has come, it will not go lower. To rush the buy is a great foolishness.*
>
> *When the force that ought to rise is spent, the place where it descends of itself — know that as the nature of heaven.*
>
> *The cheap price of the windless two-hundred-twentieth day — take it as the fixed form, receive it with the half-plank, and go.*
>
> *When a price exists such that the ten-thousand to a man have given up in weariness — that is the distant edge of the previous high-run.*
>
> *Wait for a day of rain and wind and sell rice; gain clear weather and buy rice.*

The root maxim of the section closes the twenty-eight:

> *The root source of the favorable-virtue wisdom, in the end, is the small progression — and at that source, too, benevolence stands in first place.*

7.4 Courage (勇, *Yū*) — Ten Verses

The closing rank of the Three-Virtues sequence.

> *The principle of the jewel: sell into plenty, buy into cheapness — this is the great secret of rice trading.*
>
> *If there is a thirty-percent high-low, do not be startled — face it.*[1]
>
> *Know it as principle: whenever there is a two-step-to- three-step high-low, face the rice.*

[1] *Translator's note:* Annotated in the manuscript with the Tenmei- recension marker 天明本 (*Tenmei-bon*).

> *At the thirty-percent high-low, profit reverses; to accept the loss without resistance — that is the secret.*
>
> *When ten-thousand of ten-thousand are strong-spirited, become the fool and sell the rice.*[2]
>
> *When field and mountain alike are all turned out and weak-spirited, become the dolt and buy the rice.*

And the final courage verse, which the manuscript pairs with a *kundoku* return-mark 〈レ〉 inverting its last clause:

> 三俵鞘直照可〈レ〉逆
>
> *Three*-tawara *spread-price: the reversal rule — read and reflect in reverse.*

[2] *Translator's note:* The margin here carries a second Tenmei-recension gloss in classical Chinese: 米大崩大変不可驚可買 — "Great rice-collapse, great change — do not be startled; buy."

Chapter 8

The World-Levels Diagram and the Five-Stage Secrets

Page 21 opens the manuscript's most concentrated quantitative section. Three structures dominate: the **World-Levels Diagram**, a ceremonial three-tier figure mapping the full range of the market; the **Strong-Qi Five-Stage Secret**, a schedule for scaling a long into declines; and its mirror, the **Weak-Qi Five-Stage Secret**, for scaling a short into rallies.

8.1 The World-Levels Diagram (世の中三段之図)

The page opens with two national agricultural reference-figures that frame the scale at which the whole method operates:

> *Total rice yield:* ***28,085,482*** koku.
> *Total field area:* ***947,801*** chō.

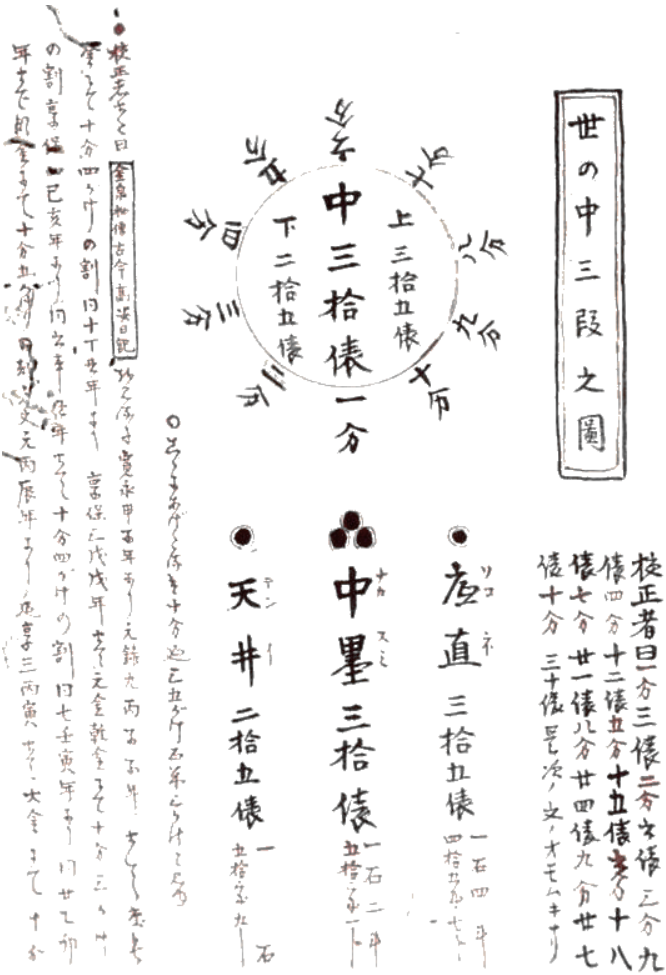

Figure 8.1: *
Manuscript page 21: the *World-Levels Diagram* (世の中三段之図). The three tiers of the figure — 上 (upper), 中墨 (middle-ink), 下 (lower) — frame the full operating range of the market around a central reference price.

The glosses for each tier, with the manuscript's weight- and-price annotations:

Level	**Tawara**	**Weight** / tawara	**Price** / tawara
● 天井 Ceiling	25	—	—
○ 上 Upper	35	一石四斗	四十五匁七分
◉ 中墨 Middle-ink (three-star)	30 + 1 bu	一石二斗	五十三匁一分
○ 下 Lower	25	一石	五十三匁九分

The 中墨 (*nakasumi*) — "middle-ink," three-starred in the original — is the figure's fulcrum: the reference price against which all further range-reading is done. A linear ten-tenths (十分 (*jippun*)) scale keyed to this level runs down the page: each *bu* (tenth) of the year's harvest estimate corresponds to three additional *tawara* on the price axis, building to thirty at ten-tenths. The manuscript then annotates a column of past historical years (寛永甲子 (*Kan'ei Kinoe-Ne*) = 1624; 元禄九丙子 (*Genroku 9 Hinoe-Ne*) = 1696; 享保 (*Kyōhō*) 1716–36; 元文丙辰 (*Genbun Hinoe-Tatsu*) = 1736) with their actual out-turns, keyed to this scale as an empirical calibration.

8.1.1 Applying the Method

The rule for using the diagram, in plain prose:

> *Using the three-level method above, one accumulates the good-and-bad of each year's world. A year of the upper division may run on for thirty years; a year of the lower division can run on for eight or nine.*
>
> *Consider the out-turn of the low ranking. In a middle- division world, if the year's estimate is seven-tenths, multiply three times seven — twenty-one tawara. Take this as the middle- ink price.*
>
> *For such a price: add six tawara of the thirty-percent drawdown buffer to get twenty-six tawara as the middle law. At year-end, this holds without variance; not even one hundredth-of- a-*monme *off.*

8.2 The Strong-Qi Five-Stage Secret (強気五ツの秘伝)

A compact five-stage buy-on-dips schedule — the heart of the book's accumulation method. It is read against a base established at the year's new-rice opening price taken as the middle-ink, and builds a long position into successive drawdowns:

Stage	Drawdown from middle-ink	Ryō
第一 First	一割半さげ 15 % down	100
第二 Second	二割さげ 20 % down	200
第三 Third	二割半さげ 25 % down	400
第四 Fourth	三割さげ 30 % down	800
第五 Fifth	三割余 over 30 %	1,000 — 2,000

> *Editor's note: These five stages are each a* tengen *trade-maxim. Whether a thousand or two thousand* ryō, *buy accordingly.*

The working rule at the first stage establishes the discipline:

> *First, reckon the year's world at ten-tenths. Even in a year where the new-rice price is exceptionally high and you are certain it ought to fall thirty percent — by no means sell.*
>
> *To buy at the one-and-a-half-tenths drawdown is the great secret. In any year, to take the new-rice opening price as the middle-ink — this is the family secret.*

The fifth-stage disposition is the book's most aggressive single instruction:

> *From a middle-ink of 20 tawara, once the drawdown runs to three-step-plus and you see 27 or 28 tawara — buy a thousand or even two thousand* ryō. *Take it as the one-man's proof-of- concept. At such a level, the decline is a "six-and-stream" event — one in a thousand.*

8.3 The Weak-Qi Five-Stage Secret (弱気五ツの秘伝)

The mirror schedule: building a short into successive rallies.

Stage	Rally from middle-ink	Ryō
第一 First	一刻半あげ 1.5-step up	100
第二 Second	二刻あげ 2-step up	200
第三 Third	二刻半あげ 2.5-step up	400
第四 Fourth	三刻あげ 3-step up	800
第五 Fifth	三割余 over 30 %	1,000 — 2,000

The editorial gloss underneath the header reads: *"Same schedule as above, one and the same person."* The two five-stage schedules are meant to be run in tandem by a single trader — long into the downside, short into the upside — with the size-doublings (100 → 200 → 400

→ 800 → 1,000+) meaning that the aggregate stake is concentrated at the market's extremities, exactly where the trader is most alone against the crowd.

Chapter 9

The Compound Trades and the Seven Fortunes

Pages 25–27 of the manuscript present the book's remaining composite trading schedules — the strong-qi / weak-qi reverse- weight (逆権), the favorable-virtue reverse-loss (順徳 逆損), the random-edge (度端), the stake-use (立用), and the follow-the-color (随色) — grouped under the chapter-heading:

> ○七福即生秘密巻目
>
> *The Secret of the Immediate Arising of the Seven Fortunes*

> *Editor's note:* The chapter's name invokes the Seven Fortunes — the seven deities of good fortune in Japanese popular religion — as an emblem of the multiplicity of the compound methods collected beneath it. What follows is a small family of trade-schedules, not a numbered list of seven conditions.

9.1 The Strong-Qi Reverse-Weight Trade (強気逆権商内)

> *The reverse-weight trading force has its middle-ink. Up through two steps there is no one-step; beyond two steps there is no five-*bu.

The trader builds a long across five scaled entries, reaching a **1,600-*ryō*** total at the extreme:

> *Cumulative: 1,600-*ryō *long held; 180* tawara *drawdown. A ten-percent rally yields 320* tawara *gain — the voice of favorable virtue.*

9.2 Favorable-Virtue Reverse-Loss Variants

Three further methods, all in the same idiom, keyed to successively larger rally thresholds:

強気一割あげ順徳逆損商内 Strong-qi ten-percent-up favorable-virtue reverse-loss. Five-way graduated scale-out (五方ならし) across a rally.

強気一割半あげ順徳逆損商内 Same schedule keyed to a 15 % rally threshold, in a tighter *tawara* band. Net: **800-*ryō* sell**, 70-*tawara* drawdown at the turn, 160-*tawara* profit per one-step decline.

強気二刻あげ順徳丞様商内 Same idiom keyed to a two-step rally. At the *tengen*-mark on the second pass, the position reverses and a further 200-*ryō* sell is initiated.

9.3 The Random-Edge Trade (度端一六の商内)

> *From a 20-tawara middle-ink, whenever the market slumps beyond three steps — or, alternately, rallies beyond three steps — always trade the one-hundred-*ryō*-sized lot at the low level.*
>
> *Even if thinking in terms of one thousand or two thousand* ryō*, pack it in lightly. Even a thirty-percent-plus drawdown is only one case in a thousand; even a thirty-percent-plus rally is only a mountain-of-one in a thousand.*

9.4 The Stake-Use Trade (立用商内)

> *In the stake-use trade, you do not speak of the gap — rather, from having heard the future ups and downs of rice, you reflect carefully and stake accordingly.*
>
> *The stake-use is not much of a wrapping-in for those who trade in large size — the reason being that when you hold a long of 50,000 or 100,000* ryō*, even if you wish to sell, as soon as you do, the side-market chases you down six or seven* bu *and can pursue you for up to a month.*

This is the book's most candid acknowledgement of market-impact. The trader who is large relative to the market's depth cannot execute at the marginal price — his own selling moves the market against him.

9.5 The Follow-the-Color Trade (随色商内)

The editor marks this method with a warning: *"this trading-force is the same as the essential trading-equipment"* — that is, it is the method a trader must already know how to handle before attempting. The method itself:

*The law of the follow-the-color trade: at those moments when the genuine awareness is dulled — when nothing exceptional has occurred, and one is inclined to say no imperial edict will come — rice suddenly rallies five-*bu *or seven-*bu. *Have that ship sold, and buy at the place where it retraces five-*bu, *seven-*bu, *seven-*bu. *This is called* follow-the-color.

Still, stake only a hundred or two hundred ryō. *Without certainty, to overdo the ease is the bold overhand of luggage.*

Chapter 10

The Grand Diagram

第三　上割三下割三之圖

Third: The Upper-Three, Lower-Three Figure

The manuscript's most elaborate single figure. It is the third — and final — of the major named diagrams in the book, following the four-stage method-figures of Chapter 4 and the World-Levels Diagram of Chapter 8. An editorial annotation at the foot of the page reads: *"This diagram is from the Tenmei-era old manuscript"* (此図は天明古写本によるなり).

10.1 The Secret of the Random Edge (度端極意の巻)

Before the diagram proper, the manuscript gives a one-sentence summary of the whole approach:

> *The trade called* random-edge *— cutting desire and releasing it is its secret. That the greater-than-a-small-gap is the favorable — this is the root of rice-trading force. Therefore, without dispersing once, one cannot hope to rally a thousand times at the child's seat.*

10.2 The Figure

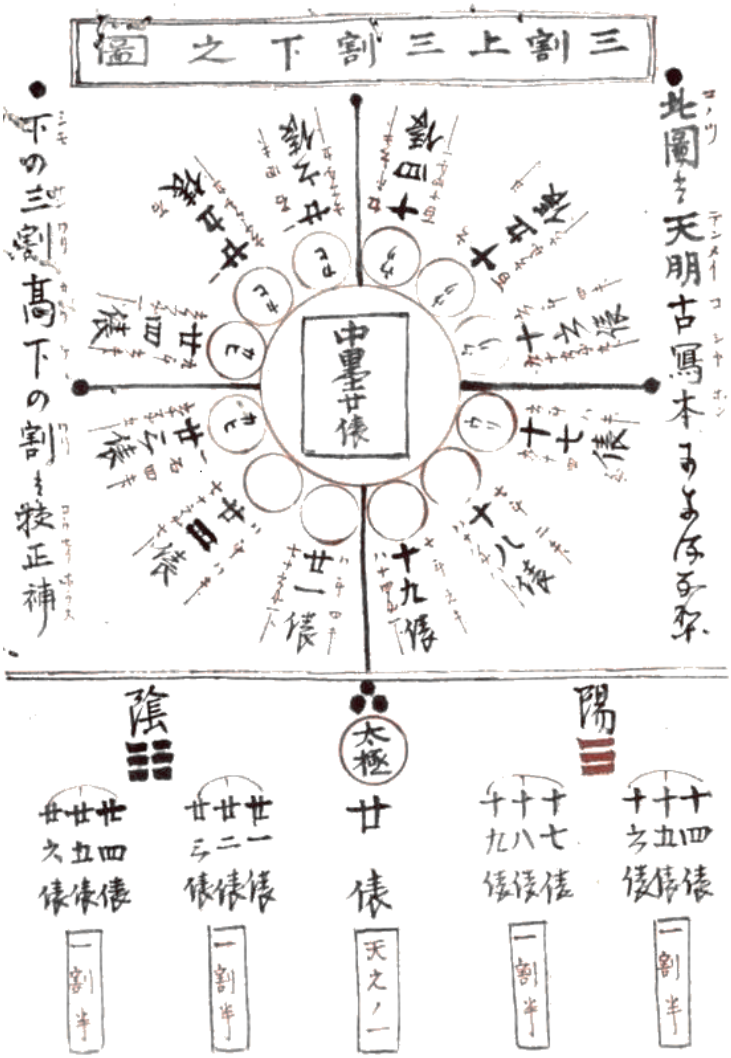

Figure 10.1: *
Manuscript page 28: the *Grand Diagram* (第三　上割三下割三之圖). At the center, a labeled box gives the 中墨 (middle-ink) reference price at 20 *tawara*. Four cardinal spokes — 上 / 下 / 東 / 西 — mark the normal bounds of the market's range, while four diagonal corners (乾 and 坤, and the two "discovery" points) fill out the eight-point orientation scheme of the classical *hakke* (eight-trigram) figure. Below the compass, four tablet-cells carry additional named *tawara* readings that elaborate the main figure's bands.

Running through all eight points are subsidiary annotations — 陽一, 陰一, 二割半, 一割半, 太極 — that mark the intermediate steps within each spoke.

10.3 Reading the Diagram

The manuscript's own prose gives the rule for interpreting the figure:

> *This diagram — take it as the secret of the random-edge. The center, in square-and-circle, figures heaven and earth.*
>
> *East-west and north-south are the four directions; adding the four corners of* ken *and* kon *brings the total to ten points of discovery.*

Four points cardinal, four diagonal, plus the center "heaven- earth" box and its ambient field: together these make the 十分 (*jippun*) — "ten-tenths" — scale referenced throughout the book's range calibrations.

Chapter 11

Strong Qi, Weak Qi, and the Three First-Tier Secrets

The manuscript closes its doctrinal chapter with an interpretation of the Grand Diagram that carries the book's most consequential empirical claim: the market's normal range is **not symmetric**.

11.1 The Bullish Bias

> *On the buying side: the principles of drought, wind-and- rain, heavenly disaster, and buying-enclosure — across spring, summer, autumn, and winter. Many are the reasons for strong spirit among those who take these as their ground.*
>
> *On the selling side: there is not one principle other than waiting for the buying-enclosure to collapse. It is for this reason that, when the diagram is laid out, there is a one-tenth strength bias on the buying side.*

This is the book's load-bearing empirical assertion: the bullish case has multiple independent triggers, the bearish case has only one. The structural drift of the rice market is therefore weakly upward.

11.2 The Effect of Strong Qi (強気の功)

A monthly weather almanac specifies exactly which bullish triggers apply in which season:

> *When wind and rain are violent, there are ship-wrecks in every season; Edo and Osaka alike have gaps in shipping. The first principle is that each person takes heed.*

3rd–4th month → 8th–9th month: When wind-and- rain are violent, the effect is flood damage to fields.

4th–5th month: Drought means no planting. Long rains rot the barley.

4th–5th month: A great wind strikes the barley.

6th–7th month: A great wind strikes the miscellaneous grains. Drought strikes field crops.

9th month: A wind strikes the rice directly.

8th–9th month: Summer rain rots the glutinous rice.

5th–6th month: Long rains bring cold that can extend half the year into a damaging autumn.

11.3 The Effect of Weak Qi (弱気の功)

The mirror case. Where strong-qi triggers rise from agricultural failure, weak-qi triggers rise from political and social shocks:

> *At the very ear of a great-high price, there will be proclamations on sake and the like — imperial notices. Besides these, there will also be proclamations of town-inspections and the like.*
>
> *Or — a wind that did not blow is said to have blown; a minor damage is spoken of as though it were the full ten-tenths; and there are years when feigned buy-ins are performed.*
>
> *Japan is the country of the gods; it is a country that takes uprightness as its root, and so the natural heaven is present above it.*

11.4 The Rarity of the Perfect Year

> *Without damage at the planting, without the heavenly disaster of drought or wind-and-rain — what one may call a world at the full ten-tenths cannot come to be more than three years in a hundred.*

Even in an abundant year, the trader is reminded that Japan is not one market: *"Even if our own country is abundant, there may be countries to east, west, south, or north that have been blown over. Do not, do not, assume from one view of a single abundant-peace-year that the whole of Japan will be likewise."*

11.5 The Three First-Tier Secrets

The chapter closes with the three numbered principles that the manuscript itself names as the first-tier family secrets — the method's most condensed opening rules:

> **1.** *Every year, read the opening trading-day level as the* middle-ink *— this is the first secret.*
>
> **2.** *Buy the middle-ink at once — this is the second.*
>
> **3.** *At the outset, stake the hundred-*ryō *trade-seal in true gold of one hundred* ryō *— this is the third secret.*

11.6 Yin-Rice and Yang-Rice (陰米陽米)

A short closing appendix returns to the cosmological vocabulary of the preface:

> *There are such things as yin-rice and yang-rice. The rice that rises is yang; the rice that falls is yin. The reason: yin rolls into yang; yang climbs directly upward.*

Chapter 12

Afterword

嘉永四年五月三日　鳴川繁楽

Third day of the fifth month, Kaei 4 — Narukawa Shigeraku

The afterword is set apart from the body of the text: on its own leaf, in dense flowing cursive, on paper that has taken heavy water- and insect-damage. It is signed 鳴川繁楽 (*Narukawa Shigeraku*) — a pen-name likely referring to the same editor whose formal name, 鳴川猛之助 (*Narukawa Takenosuke*), appears on the printed colophon of the opening leaf.

> *Editor's note:* The afterword is the hardest page in the manuscript. Even the NDL's specialist OCR returns significant stretches as fragmentary. What follows is the reconstruction of its *apparent sense* rather than a character-by-character translation; readers who wish to cite from the afterword should consult the manuscript image directly.

12.1 The Opening Invocation

> *In the present age, faced with the needs before me, the lateness of the work — I have seen much that is lamented before it has even been seen — letters on fine papers, matters now reduced to paper-scraps.*

12.2 The Central Worry: One Step, a Thousand

Ri

The editor's governing anxiety is stated plainly in the middle of the text, through a classical proverb:

> *When the early-spring buying is applied [wrongly], it becomes, as the saying has it, a "one-step error, thousand-*ri *deviation" — and, without helping, reversed, it turns instead into a great tree-land mistake.*

The proverb 一歩千里のちがい — *a single misplaced step, a thousand-ri deviation* — is the editorial concern of the whole project: the book is a secret-transmission text in which a small error in reading propagates catastrophically into trading practice.

12.3 Why Publish Now

> *Over these four or five years [of study], with the limited daughter-of-time, the [corrected] manuscripts that people have been copying and passing on — many have grown too old and would be the opposite of right; wishing to pull one out, compare, and set things right, I have put my hand aside, but the present-life-edition cannot yet be called settled.*
>
> *And yet, as I say — ever since I entered upon this path, the wood-bark years of my own life have gathered, and I still fear whether I may have, in selecting Ushida Daisuke as the groundwork, introduced some deviation from his intent.*

> *Editor's note:* The name 牛田大介 (*Ushida Daisuke*) appears here. Whether *Daisuke* is a variant or *hon*-name of 牛田権三郎 (*Gonzaburō*) — the named author of the printed colophon — or a separate figure in the Ushida transmission line, is not made explicit in the surviving text. The uncertainty is preserved rather than smoothed: if the two are the same man, this is the afterword's clearest evidence of that fact; if they are different, the editor's worry is about his choice of source among multiple Ushida transmissions.

12.4 The Appeal to the Discerning Reader

> *It is for those with seeing eyes (具眼の人, gugan no hito) to take the matter up: if any public court or six [witnesses] can be found, run the path to the heights and put it to the test.*

The afterword closes with its date and signature:

> **嘉永四年五月三日**
>
> *Third day of the fifth month, Kaei 4 — the Gregorian date approximately* **May 2, 1851**.
>
> **鳴川繁楽**
>
> *Narukawa Shigeraku.*

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Glossary of Key Terms

逢来 (*airai*)
Adverse conditions; a period of generally falling prices, typically lasting roughly three years within a twelve-to-thirteen-year cycle.

安楽 (*anraku*)
"At ease"; the second of the four-stage method diagrams (Chapter 4). A net-flat cycle of four alternating 100-*ryō* buys and sells — so called because the trader carries no overnight directional exposure.

智 (*chi*)
Wisdom; the first of the *three* trading virtues (□□□). Seeing the pattern, knowing the season.

帳合米 (*chōaimai*)
"Book rice"; forward contracts on rice, as opposed to physical rice.

中墨 (*nakasumi* / *chūboku*)
"Middle-ink"; the three-starred center-cell of the World-Levels Diagram (Chapter 8); the reference price against which the five-stage strong-qi and weak-qi schedules are read. Taken each year as the new-rice opening price.

度端 (*dohan*)
"Random-edge"; the family of discretionary scaling trades presented on page 28 under the heading 度端極意の巻 ("The Secret of the Random-Edge").

堂島 (*Dōjima*)
The Dōjima Rice Exchange in Osaka; the central marketplace for rice futures trading during the Edo period.

半板 (*hanban*)
"Half-plank"; the first of the four-stage method diagrams (Chapter 4). A net-long cycle of 1000-*ryō* buys alternating with 500-*ryō* sells — the trader is always running with half his plank still underfoot.

穂足 (*hosoku*)
"Spike-foot," or the ear-of-grain figure; the foundational candle-pattern metaphor introduced in the preface, from the shape of the rice grain itself (round in the middle, pointed at top and bottom).

仁 (*jin*)
Benevolence; the second of the three trading virtues, and the largest of the three verse-ranks (twenty-eight of the forty-eight verses). Patience, waiting, not rushing.

人気 (*jinki*)
"People-qi"; market sentiment; the collective mood of traders.

慈雲斎 (*Jiunsai*)
Ushida Gonzaburō's pen name; appears once in the manuscript immediately above his given name (page 5), attached to the text's original composition in Hōreki 5 (1755).

順来 (*junrai*)
Favorable conditions; a period of generally rising prices, typically lasting roughly ten years in a twelve-to-thirteen-year cycle.

順徳 (*juntoku*)
"Favorable virtue"; the positive-expectancy direction of the compound reverse-loss trades of Chapter 9.

禁制 (*kinsei*)
"Prohibition"; the closing clause-word of each of the Fifteen Prohibitions (Chapter 3).

古米 (*komai*)
Old rice; rice from previous harvests.

空理 (*kūri*)
"Empty principle"; the preface's term for the inherent formlessness of market motion. Paired with 定式 (*jōshiki*, "fixed form") in the philosophical move that justifies the whole project: the motion is empty, yet has a form, and from the form a method can be derived.

両 (*ryō*)
The gold coin unit of the Edo period; the standard unit of capital.

新米 (*shinmai*)
New rice; freshly harvested rice. The opening trading-day price of new rice is taken as the *nakasumi* each year.

底 (*soko*)
Bottom or floor; the lowest point of the price range.

太極 (*taikyoku*)
Supreme Ultimate; the Neo-Confucian concept representing undifferentiated unity. Opens the preface; named in the Nine-Body Song (Chapter 6).

俵 (*tawara* / *hyō*)
A bale of rice; the standard unit of measure and price quotation.

天元 (*tengen*)
"Celestial origin"; the top stage-marker of every position ladder in the book — the baseline price around which accumulation and distribution ladders are calibrated.

天井 (*tenjō*)
Ceiling; the top of the price range on the World-Levels Diagram.

転変 (*tenpen*)
"Reversal"; the third of the four-stage method diagrams (Chapter 4). A net-short cycle of 1000-*ryō* buys alternating with 2000-*ryō* sells — each sell simultaneously unwinds the prior buy and opens an equal-size short.

天明本 (*Tenmei-bon*)
"Tenmei recension"; the margin-annotation marker that recurs throughout the book indicating a parallel reading from a Tenmei-era (1781–1789) version of the text.

強気 (*kyōki*)
Strong qi; bullish sentiment or upward force. One of the two central force-concepts of the book.

運気 (*unki*)
Fortune-qi; the prevailing momentum of a given period. Compiled as an almanac in Chapter 5, the 万歳運気豊凶録.

弱気 (*jakki* / *yowaki*)
Weak qi; bearish sentiment or downward force.

勇 (*yū*)
Courage; the third of the three trading virtues. Acting against the crowd when the signs align.

随色 (*zuishoku*)
"Follow-the-color"; the discretionary short-rally-fade trade of Chapter 9.

About the Editor

Zach Booth is a software engineer at NASA Ames Research Center, where he uses AI systems—including Claude (Anthropic)—in his daily engineering workflow. Self-taught in Japanese since the age of eighteen and conversational in the language, he identified this manuscript in the Kyoto University Rare Materials Digital Archive and recognized that no accurate English translation existed.

He directed the translation using the same AI tools he works with professionally, but with a hard separation between the two stages: the cursive-to-Japanese reading was handled by NDL 古典籍OCR-Lite, a specialist character-recognition model from Japan's National Diet Library, while the Japanese-to-English rendering was handled by an LLM working only from the mechanical OCR output. Every editorial decision can be checked end-to-end: every English sentence traces to a specific line of NDL-OCR transcription, which traces to a specific region of the manuscript scan.

This is his first published translation. The complete source materials—original manuscript scans, character-by-character transcription with confidence levels, working translation files, and LaTeX source—are available at:
https://github.com/groverburger/sanen-kinsen-hiroku

Appendix A

Position Calculation Ladders

This appendix collects the manuscript's explicit position-building ladders — the quantitative apparatus behind the method-diagrams of Chapter 4 and the five-stage secrets of Chapter 8. The manuscript presents these as tight vertical columns of tawara-count, weight and price annotations around a central diagram. The tables below preserve the three explicit capital totals that the manuscript itself states in plain prose, together with the stage-names in their native sequence.

A.1 The Autumn-Moon 800-Ryō Ladder (秋名月商内)

From page 10 of the manuscript. Six named stages building an **800-*ryō*** long position from a 20-*tawara* middle-ink base.

Stage	Japanese	Ryō	Action
Celestial origin	天元	100	sell / reference
First step	一乗	100	(100-*ryō* sell)
Second coming	二来	400	sell
Three flats	三平	200	sell
Half-plank	半板	800	buy (reversal anchor)
At ease	安楽	800	final position

Summed totals (manuscript):
800-*ryō* buy; 70 *tawara* accumulated;
∼30 *ryō* payment; 40 *ryō* deposit; 70 *ryō* total.

> *Editor's note:* The oral tradition pinned to this ladder declares its use plainly: *"In the harvest-moon trade, one ought to use this diagram as the square-rule and trade by it."* A mirror instruction at the foot of the page establishes reversibility: *"When reversed, it becomes an 800-ryō sell."* The same ladder is the square-rule for the two-hundred-tenth-day trade as well.

A.2 The Ebisu 600-Ryō Sell-Ladder

From page 11. The 600-*ryō* distributional variant, dedicated to Nishinomiya Ebisu and Sumiyoshi Daimyōjō, keyed to the late-fifth-month pivot.

Stage	Japanese	Ryō	Action
Celestial origin	天元	100	sell / reference
One flat	一平	100	sell
Two flats	二平	200	sell
Distribution	出染	100	sell

Summed:
400-*ryō* sell; 30 *tawara* loss;
∼15 *ryō* payment; 10+ *ryō* deposit.
Profit-rice 160 *tawara*, less 30 bucket = **130**.

A.3 The Strong-Qi Five-Stage Secret

From page 22. The five-stage buy-on-dips schedule of Chapter 8, reproduced here in tabular form for reference.

Stage	Drawdown from middle-ink	Ryō
第一 First	15 % down (一割半さげ)	100
第二 Second	20 % down (二割さげ)	200
第三 Third	25 % down (二割半さげ)	400
第四 Fourth	30 % down (三割さげ)	800
第五 Fifth	over 30 % (三割余)	1,000 – 2,000

At each stage, from a 20-*tawara* middle-ink base:
800-*ryō* long cumulative; ∼70 *tawara* drawdown at entry;
160 *tawara* profit per one-step (一刻) rally.

A.4 The Weak-Qi Five-Stage Secret

The mirror schedule, from page 24 of the manuscript. Build a short into successive rallies:

Stage	Rally from middle-ink	Ryō
第一 First	1.5-step up (一刻半あげ)	100
第二 Second	2-step up (二刻あげ)	200
第三 Third	2.5-step up (二刻半あげ)	400
第四 Fourth	3-step up (三刻あげ)	800
第五 Fifth	over 30 % (三割余)	1,000 – 2,000

At each stage:
800-*ryō* short cumulative; ∼60–70 *tawara* loss at the turn; 160 *tawara* profit per one-step decline.

Editor's note: The editor's gloss under the header of this schedule reads: *"Same schedule as above, one and the same person."* The two five-stage ladders — strong-qi accumulation and weak-qi distribution — are meant to be run in tandem by a single trader. The position-size doublings (100 → 200 → 400 → 800 → 1,000+) concentrate the aggregate stake at the market's extremities, where the trader is most alone against the crowd.

End of the Complete Volume

全 — *Zen*